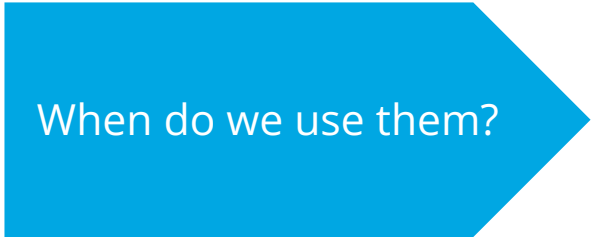


COMPARATIVES & SUPERLATIVES

Comparative and superlative adjectives

Let's look at:

1. When we use comparative and superlative adjectives.
2. How we make comparative adjectives.
3. How we make superlative adjectives.



When do we use them?

Function: When do we use comparative adjectives?



The red car is bigger than the blue car. It is better and more comfortable for the children.

Comparing them.

Two cars – the red car and the blue car.

Is he describing the cars or comparing them?

Look at what the man says: 'The red car is bigger than the blue car.' Is he talking about one or two cars?



I'm not sure. The red car is older than the blue car and I think the blue car is nicer. Let's buy the blue car. I am happier with it.



Which picture is correct?

A.



A.

B.



How many examples of comparing can you find in the conversation?

Six.

Let's see where they are...

Function: When do we use comparative and superlative adjectives?



1. Comparative adjectives: to compare two people, things or places.

The red car is bigger than the blue car.

Here are the two objects.

The red car is older than the blue car.

It is better.

It is more comfortable for the children.

In these four examples, we don't need to mention both objects because we know we are talking about the red and blue cars.

I am happier with it.

The blue car is nicer.

It (the red car) is better (than the blue car).

It (the red car) is more comfortable (than the blue car).

I am happier with it (the blue car than the red car).

The blue car is nicer (than the red car).

Function: When do we use superlative adjectives?



No. Not the blue car, please! It's the most expensive car here. I think it's the worst car in the shop.

Ok. And the yellow car? It's the cheapest car in the shop, but it is also the biggest. What do you think?



Look! Superlatives and comparatives are different.

Comparative: compares two objects.

The red car is bigger than the blue car.

Superlative: compares one object to a group of objects.

The blue car is the most expensive car (in the shop).

Look at what the man says: '*It's the most expensive car here.*' Is he comparing the blue car to one other car or all the cars in the shop?

*All the cars
(a group of cars).*



How many examples of superlative adjectives can you find?

Four.

Let's see where they are...

Function: When do we use comparative and superlative adjectives?



1. Comparative adjectives: to compare two people, things or places.

The red car is bigger than the blue car.

Here are the two objects.

The red car is older than the blue car.

It is better.

It is more comfortable for the children.

In these four examples, we don't need to mention both objects because we know we are talking about the red and blue cars.

I am happier with it.

The blue car is nicer.

It (the red car) is better (than the blue car).

It (the red car) is more comfortable (than the blue car).

I am happier with it (the blue car than the red car).

The blue car is nicer (than the red car).

2. Superlative adjectives: to compare one person, thing, etc. to a group.

It's the most expensive car here.

It's the worst car in the shop.

Here, the man and woman are comparing **one** car to **all** the cars in the shop (**a group** of cars).

It's the cheapest car in the shop.

It's the biggest in the shop.

How do we make comparative adjectives?

Form: How do we make comparative adjectives?



The red car is bigger than the blue car. It is better and more comfortable for the children.

I'm not sure. The red car is older than the blue car and I think the blue car is nicer. Let's buy the blue car. I am happier with it.

Look at the conversation again and use the examples to complete the table below. The first one is done for you.

Now look at the rules and add them to the table. The first one is done for you.

types of adjectives	comparative adjectives	
short adjectives (one syllable)	older (old)	
adjectives ending in -e	nicer (nice)	
one syllable adjectives ending in a vowel and then a consonant	bigger (big)	
two syllable adjectives ending in -y	happier (happy)	
long adjectives (more than two syllables)	more	
irregular adjectives	comfortable better (good)	no rule

double
consonant + -er + -r

+ -er more +
adjective

delete -y + -ier

Form: How do we make comparative and superlative adjectives?



types of adjectives	comparative adjectives	
short adjectives (one syllable)	older (old)	+ -er
adjectives ending in -e	nicer (nice)	+ -r
one syllable adjectives ending in a vowel and then a consonant	bigger (big)	double consonant + -er
two syllable adjectives ending in -y	happier (happy)	delete -y + -ier
long adjectives (more than two syllables)	more comfortable (comfortable)	more + adjective
irregular adjectives	better (good) worse (bad) further (far)	no rule

We use comparative adjectives + *than* to compare two objects, people or places. Look...

The red car is **bigger than** the blue car.

The red car is **more comfortable than** the blue car.

Here are some other examples of irregular comparative adjectives.

How do we make superlative adjectives?

comparative adjective + *than*...

e.g. The red car is bigger than the blue car.

Form: How do we make superlative adjectives?



No. Not the blue car, please! It's the most expensive car here. I think it's the worst car in the shop.

Ok. And the yellow car? It's the cheapest car in the shop, but it is also the biggest. What do you think?

Look at the conversation again and use the examples to complete the table below. Some examples are done for you.

Now look at the rules and add them to the table. The first one is done for you.

types of adjectives	comparative adjectives	
short adjectives (one syllable)	the cheapest (cheap)	
adjectives ending in -e	the nicest (nice)	
one syllable adjectives ending in a vowel and then a consonant.	the biggest (big)	
two syllable adjectives ending in -y	the happiest (happy)	
long adjectives (more than two syllables)	the most expensive	
irregular adjectives	the worst (bad)	no rule

the + double
consonant + -est

the + -st

the + -est

the most +
adjective

the + delete -y + -iest

Form: How do we make comparative and superlative adjectives?



Don't forget
the!

types of adjectives	comparative adjectives		superlative adjectives	
short adjectives (one syllable)	older (old)	+ -er	the cheapest (cheap)	<i>the</i> + -est
adjectives ending in -e	nicer (nice)	+ -r	the nicest (nice)	<i>the</i> + -st
one syllable adjectives ending in a vowel and then a consonant	bigger (big)	double consonant + -er	the biggest (big)	<i>the</i> + double consonant + -est
two syllable adjectives ending in -y	happier (happy)	delete -y + -ier	the happiest (happy)	<i>the</i> + delete -y + -est
long adjectives (more than two syllables)	more comfortable (comfortable)	<i>more</i> + adjective	the most expensive (expensive)	<i>the most</i> + adjective
irregular adjectives	better (good) worse (bad) further (far)	no rule	the best (good) the worst (bad) the furthest (far)	no rule

The rules are very similar for both.

We often use expressions like *in the world, in the school, in the class, in the shop* with superlative structures.

Let's
practise!

Practice activities

Complete the gaps with the correct form of the comparative or superlative structures. Use the adjectives in brackets.

1. My apartment is..... (good) in the whole building because it has more light.
2. I think my dad's job is.....(easy) than my mum's. He gets more time off.
3. Is this film.....(good) than the film we watched last week? I hope so!
4. Maria is.....(intelligent) person in the school. She studies so hard!
5. Look! My dog is.....(happy) in the park. He loves playing.
6. A: It is very hot today! B: I think it was.....(hot) yesterday .